

GPUs

Which graphics card should you invest in?

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If we were to print out every request for a graphics card recommendation then we'd probably be able to put together a house of cards. We aren't even going to bother with the whole thing of not buying a graphics card based on how much video memory a card has since it's common knowledge these days.

What matters is how much you're willing to pay to get what you want. Mid-range is the best place to get your



The GTX 760 is a beauty!

money's worth. The low end SKUs are simply not worth the money if you're going to spend ₹60,000 on rig. The bare minimum you need to get would be a GTX 660 or a GTX 660 Ti when it comes to NVIDIA and the R9 270 from AMD does an equally good job. But as you spend more and approach the ₹80,000 mark then you should start considering the GTX 760 and the AMD R9 280 or the R9 280X for a few bucks extra.

As you approach the ₹35,000-40,000 mark you should start worrying about power consumption and heat generation since we've entered the realm of SLI / Crossfire.

We're seeing price cuts across the entire range at the moment so by the time this article comes out you might be wondering whether this was written while the author was zonked out. But that's not the case. A GTX 760 stock card costs about ₹16,000 online and getting two for SLI would cost ₹32,000 which is exactly the same as getting a stock GTX 780. The difference is that the SLI configuration performs way better than a single GTX 780. So you get about 30-40% more performance but the power consumption goes up by 40-50% which is where your worries begin. However, the exact is not true for AMD since two R9 270X cards in Crossfire don't make for a better option compared to the R9 290. The R9 290 is a better solution since it is based on a different architecture (Hawaii) which is much more efficient and ends up crunching more numbers at a much lower net wattage when compared to the R9 270X Crossfire setup. However, with AMD comes better compute capabilities and it's preferred if you wish to try out a better parallel computation programming.

NVIDIA's new Maxwell based GTX 980 which costs ₹46,000 can be considered for really high end rigs since it does the same or better job as a factory overclocked GTX 780 Ti but with a much lower power consumption, the bragging rights are free. 

BEST ★ ★ BLUETOOTH SPEAKERS



JBL CHARGE

The Charge combines a power bank with speakers, without compromising on audio quality.



LOGITECH X100

A pint-sized bluetooth speaker that gives great sound but won't burn a hole in your pocket.



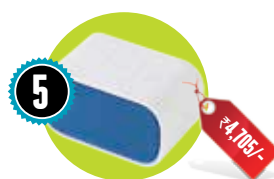
BOSE SOUNDLINK II

For those who want a serious listening experience, this is the best audio quality you can find.



BOSE SOUNDLINK MINI

Again for serious listeners, this is a more compact version of the bigger SoundLink II.



ULTIMATE EARS MOBILE BOOMBOX

If you want a sound upgrade over the X100 without breaking the bank, this speaker is a good deal.

TOP ★ ★ PHABLETS



SAMSUNG GALAXY NOTE 4

Undoubtedly the best large screen smartphone in the market today. Need we say more?



HTC DESIRE 816

The Desire 816 stands tall here thanks to great looks, design combined with excellent price.



LG G PRO 2

Another great LG product that performs well, offers a good feature set and doesn't cost much.



OPPO FIND 7

The Find 7 came out of nowhere this year to become one of the best large-screen smartphones.



NOKIA LUMIA 1520

Perfect for those of you looking for a large screen smartphone running Windows. Great camera.